

Chapter 111-2

Gu Xingyue looked at Liang Shi. "What did you want to find me for before? To sue Yang Jiani?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "The boundaries of domestic violence are too broad. Even suing her wouldn't be enough to put her in prison. But Qi Jiao has been dead for less than twenty years—we can still get justice for her."

At first, Liang Shi had wanted to confirm the authenticity of that memory. Later, she wanted to make Yang Jiani pay the price.

But she hadn't expected it to be tangled up in such a big matter.

Yang Jiani was too bold.

Or rather, she had already gone insane. This was absolutely not something a normal person could do.

Liang Shi even felt that even if they sued Yang Jiani, she might ultimately escape legal punishment by pleading mental illness.

Now that she knew, there was no reason to pretend to be deaf and mute.

Just based on what happened in childhood, Liang Shi felt she should get justice for Qi Jiao.

She couldn't just die for no reason like that, unable to even possess her own name.

She should be Qi Jiao—Qi Jiao who lived for herself.

Gu Xingyue looked at her. "But there's a problem now. If we want to get justice for Qi Jiao, I would have to come forward. I would have to say that I am Gu Xingyue, that the real Qi Jiao is dead. But no one knows how she died, and there's no evidence pointing to Yang Jiani as the culprit, because Yang Jiani is Qi Jiao's biological mother."

Unless there was very direct video evidence, it would be impossible to prove.

There might even be no one who would believe that a mother would kill her own daughter.

Even if it was just accidentally pushing her off.

But long ago, Yang Jiani had already killed Qi Jiao's soul.

The diary Qi Jiao left behind could only serve as indirect evidence to prove that Yang Jiani had committed domestic violence. But Qi Jiao was dead, and the authenticity of that diary could not be verified.

Everything seemed to be covering for Yang Jiani's actions.

She was an adult, and Qi Jiao was a child.

So the violence an adult inflicted on a child could be disguised under the skin of familial love.

Thus the violence was rationalized.

This in itself was the most unreasonable thing.

The line between disciplining a child through hitting and scolding and domestic violence was too weak.

There were always people exploiting loopholes in the law, standing at the edge of morality.

"I won't come forward." Gu Xingyue directly stated her position. "If I come forward, I would betray the director. I can't possibly do that."

Liang Shi asked, "Does Yang Jiani have something on the director?"

Gu Xingyue paused for a moment, but ultimately chose not to hide it and honestly nodded.

"So you became Qi Jiao as an exchange, right?" Liang Shi asked again.

Gu Xingyue nodded again. Considering that she didn't have much time, she said directly, "I can't talk about the orphanage matters, but the director handed me over to Yang Jiani back then because of my illness. Yang Jiani could pay for my medical treatment, so the director gave me to her and had me become her daughter."

"If it weren't for my illness, even if Yang Jiani had something on the director, he wouldn't have handed me over to her." Gu Xingyue said, "As for Qi Jiao's matter, I've thought about it carefully. All the legitimate paths won't work. If you want to get justice for Qi Jiao, the only way is to kill, but you would be punished for it. It's not worth it."

At this moment, Gu Xingyue analyzed the current situation—calm and composed, her tone carrying indifference and disgust.

When speaking of the final outcome, there was only mockery.

But Liang Shi felt a sense of powerlessness listening to this.

The law exists to guarantee everyone's rights—life and death, crime and punishment.

Including bad people.

The unforgivably wicked, the perpetually evil, the crazed and inhumane.

They were all within the scope of legal protection.

The law was the most inhumane thing, yet it also had warmth.

But in this situation, it was a dead end with no solution.

After a brief moment of powerlessness, Liang Shi quickly adjusted her mindset and asked Gu Xingyue, "Then do you have any ideas?"

"I haven't figured it out yet." Gu Xingyue said, "I need some time."

Liang Shi looked at her. "Then be careful and stay safe. But you mentioned Chen Mian on the phone earlier—what does she have to do with this matter?"

"Do you remember the paper I gave you?" Gu Xingyue asked. "It was Qi Jiao's diary. It mentioned someone she once had a secret crush on—that person was Chen Mian."

Liang Shi was startled. "What? My sister really likes this artist. She and I used to be art studio classmates. She's a bit older than me."

"Yes." Gu Xingyue said, "She was in the same class as Qi Jiao. The night before last, I received a phone call from her."

Liang Shi quickly processed this information, then thought of the original owner's one interaction with Chen Mian in the art studio.

Calculating the time, it was right when Qi Jiao hadn't died yet.

At that time, Chen Mian had said two cryptic sentences, carrying a hint of contempt.